

BONUS GUIDE

The Sell-Your-Stitches Kit

Your Guide to Turning Thread Into Income

Everything you need to price, photograph, list, and sell your
paper embroidery — online and in person.

THE EVENING STITCH™

1. Is Your Work Ready to Sell?

If you've completed at least 10 patterns from different collections and received a compliment from someone who isn't your mother, your work is ready. Seriously.

The Quality Checklist

- Thread tension is even throughout (no loose loops, no warping)
- The back is clean and neatly taped
- Colors are intentional and harmonious
- The card is free of stains, pencil marks, and bent corners
- The piece is mounted or framed neatly

The Comparison Trap

You will always think your work isn't good enough. This is normal. The buyer doesn't compare your piece to perfection — they compare it to a blank wall. If it makes them smile, it's good enough to sell.

2. Pricing Your Work

The Formula

$$\text{Price} = (\text{Materials} \times 2) + (\text{Time} \times \text{Your Hourly Rate}) + \text{Profit Margin}$$

Example: A Framed Mandala

Component	Cost
Cardstock	\$0.50
Thread (3 colors)	\$1.50
Frame (shadow box)	\$12.00
Materials subtotal × 2	\$28.00
Time: 3 hours × \$15/hr	\$45.00
Profit margin (20%)	\$14.60
Selling price	\$87.60 → Round to \$88 or \$89

Price Tiers by Product Type

Product	Price Range (USD)
Greeting cards (unframed)	\$8 – \$15
Small framed piece (4×6 in)	\$25 – \$45
Medium framed piece (6×8 in)	\$50 – \$90
Large framed piece (8×10+ in)	\$80 – \$150
Custom/commission	\$100 – \$250+
Set of 5 greeting cards	\$35 – \$55

Never price below materials × 3. If your materials cost \$14 and you’re selling for \$30, you’re working for less than \$5/hour. Your time has value.

3. Selling on Etsy

Setting Up Your Shop

1. **Shop name:** Short, memorable, related to your craft. Check availability before falling in love with a name.
2. **Shop banner:** Clean photo of your best piece, well-lit, minimal text.
3. **About section:** Your story: when you started, what you love about it, what makes your work unique. Buyers connect with makers.
4. **Policies:** Be clear about returns (handmade = no returns on custom work), shipping times, and packaging.

Listing Optimization

- **Title:** Start with what it is: "Paper Embroidery Mandala Wall Art — Framed Geometric String Art — Handmade Gift"
- **Tags:** Use all 13 tags. Mix broad (paper embroidery, wall art) with specific (geometric mandala, thread art).
- **Description:** Size, materials, colors, care instructions, shipping details. Front-load the key info.
- **Photos:** 10 allowed — use them all. (See the photography section.)
- **Categories:** Art & Collectibles → Mixed Media & Collage → Paper

Etsy Fees (2026)

Listing fee: \$0.20/item • Transaction fee: 6.5% • Payment processing: 3% + \$0.25.

For a \$50 item, total fees are approximately \$5.15 (10.3%). Factor this into your pricing.

4. Photography That Sells

Your photos are your storefront. A \$100 piece photographed poorly looks like a \$10 piece. A \$30 piece photographed well looks like a \$60 piece.

The Essential Shots (in order)

1. **Hero shot:** The piece at a slight angle, natural light, clean background
2. **Flat lay:** Straight above, showing the full design clearly
3. **Detail close-up:** Thread texture, the precision of holes, color detail
4. **Scale shot:** Piece next to a common object (hand, coffee cup, book) or on a wall
5. **Lifestyle shot:** Piece displayed in a real room setting
6. **Back view:** Shows the quality of your finishing (for buyers who care about craft)
7. **Packaging shot:** How it arrives — this builds confidence in shipping

Quick Setup (No Studio Needed)

- **Light:** Window light. Face the piece toward the window, shoot from the other side.
- **Background:** White poster board or a linen cloth. Avoid busy surfaces.
- **Camera:** Any smartphone made after 2020 is more than good enough.
- **Editing:** Brighten slightly, increase contrast slightly. Don't filter the colors.

Golden hour: The best natural light for craft photography is 1–2 hours before sunset. The warm, diffused light makes thread colors glow and eliminates harsh shadows.

5. Local Markets & Craft Fairs

Finding Events

- Search "[your city] craft fair" or "[your city] handmade market"
- Check community boards at libraries, coffee shops, and craft stores
- Join local maker groups on social media
- Holiday markets (November–December) are the highest-selling season

Your Booth Essentials

Item	Why
Table cover (neutral fabric)	Professional base for your display
Risers / small shelves	Create height variation — flat tables look boring
Price tags	Always label. People won't ask the price; they'll walk away.
Business cards	For people who want to order later
Card reader (Square/Stripe)	Accept cards — doubles your sales vs. cash only
A live demo piece	Stitching at the booth draws people in like a magnet

Pricing for Markets

Price the same as online. If someone asks for a deal, offer a bundle: "One card is \$12, or pick any three for \$30." Never undercut your own Etsy shop — it trains customers to look for the cheaper option.

The Demo Effect

Sit at your booth and stitch. People will stop, watch, ask questions, and buy. It's the single most effective selling technique at markets. You're not performing — you're just making your next piece. The craft sells itself when people see it happening.

Your Next Step

Pick one selling channel — Etsy or a local market — and commit to listing or booking your first event within 7 days. Start with 5 pieces ready to sell.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here